



The marketing that we do is intentional; that is, we want to put products and resources in front of engineers to help them do their jobs. If we know they're a wireless engineer, or they're interested in semiconductors, or they prefer a certain list of manufacturers, we want to make sure that the marketing we show them is relevant to them and helps them do their job, instead of just delivering the same message to anybody who might be interested in Mouser.

At Mouser, do you see the entire gamut, the delivery of the product, service, etc., as a part of marketing? Or are all of them different functions?

They are all separate but definitely related. But marketing would have nothing to talk about if not for the teams in our global distribution centre who pull and ship orders with exceptional speed and accuracy. And our sales and service teams have to be best in class: When a customer calls, they need to receive the best customer service experience they've ever had. Our website must also be the best or we would have no place to send customers. And we also have many people behind the scenes to support our 650,000+ customers worldwide, transacting in different languages, currencies, and time zones. And if it weren't for our products team ensuring we have inventory from leading manufacturers on the shelf, we would have nothing to talk about. So, marketing is the vehicle to talk about all these teams who do such impressive work.

Are the marketing teams becoming more techie?

Oh yes! By the very nature of our business, part of our role in marketing is to educate the engineers and buyers about new technologies and new products launched, giving them a sneak peek into the latest trends and upcoming tech. And that requires engineers who know marketing. With

an avenue like marketing emails, it's all about data and metrics. It's all about knowing what the customers are looking for and being able to deliver a customised message. So yes, marketing is turning techie. It's turning into people who are smart, understand data and can make adjustments based on what the data is telling us. We are constantly evaluating and assessing to continue structuring the perfect team.

How do you see the role of traditional creative people like copywriters? Are they now rendering a supporting function to the techies who have become the drivers handling the tools?

I truly believe in teamwork. So, to me, when you have more technical people coming up with ideas, you also need the support of the copywriters, design, and marketing automation teams in order to deliver a polished message. And then you need the marketing communications team to figure out where it can go. Otherwise, it's just static content that doesn't make it to everybody who might want to see it.

It has to be a combination of marketing, communications, and social media—the last of which plays a huge role throughout the world, especially to engage with younger engineers.

There's a talk about cookies being removed over a couple of years. Your take?

As for cookies, that really stings. Because there are a lot of sites that collect cookies and then just bombard you with whatever they want. We're not going to do that; our marketing needs to be intentional. We want those cookies to get smarter with our marketing target, instead of trying to get intrusive with our marketing. So yes, it hurts that within the next few years, third-party cookies might get wiped out altogether. Our industry and many others will

have to find other ways. We have first-party cookies on Mouser.com that follow users when they access the site. We're able to use that intelligence with our marketing automation software. But as it gets more difficult to learn people's interests, habits, and preferences, it's going to be unfortunate from a marketing standpoint.

How was Covid period for e-commerce players like Mouser?

At Mouser, we were very fortunate to weather Covid from a business standpoint, but we had a lot to go through in order to ride that wave. Within two weeks, we had to have everybody working from home—it was quite an undertaking but we were able to do it. People had to learn how to source products online and how to place orders. And one trend we did see at the beginning of the pandemic was that, all of a sudden, all these new personal accounts started to pop up. As engineers were no longer working in their offices, they were creating personal accounts with Mouser to have parts shipped. So, there was a big adjustment for many. Luckily, Mouser was already a leading e-commerce distributor. But the biggest challenge was making sure everyone had everything they needed to do their jobs completely from their homes.

You were one of the drivers of establishing Mouser's presence in Asia and in India. So, how are you seeing their evolution with respect to the overall global business of Mouser?

Oh, it's a huge part of our business now. I think India is growing 25% YoY. India's run rate hovers around 66 million this year. So, it is growing by leaps and bounds as India increases its tech design and manufacturing. And there's so much more work for us to do in India. Asia is making a comeback this year. They're growing at about 28-29% over last year.